

PREMIUM GUIDE

PENNSYLVANIA STATE UNIVERSITY

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

University Park, Pennsylvania

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1. Pennsylvania State University at a Glance

#83

QS RANKING

1855

FOUNDED

47,000

STUDENTS

1,500+

INDIAN STUDENTS

90%

PLACEMENT RATE

Attribute	Details
Full Name	Pennsylvania State University
Location	University Park, Pennsylvania, USA
Type	Public (Est. 1855)
Acceptance Rate	54%
Student-Faculty Ratio	14:1
Graduation Rate	72%
International Students	15%
Gender Ratio	48:52 (F:M)
Website	psu.edu
Motto	Happy Valley — 1,500+ Indian Students

Penn State is a public research university in University Park, Pennsylvania. With 1,500+ Indian students, it has one of the largest Indian communities among US public universities. Known for its strong engineering, CS, and business programs, Penn State offers an authentic American college experience in the scenic Happy Valley.

Notable Alumni

Guion Bluford

— First African American astronaut in space

John Cappelletti

— Heisman Trophy winner

2. Why Choose Pennsylvania?

- QS #83 — top public university
- 1,500+ Indian students — massive Indian community
- Top 30 in Engineering and CS
- Beautiful campus in Happy Valley — scenic and safe
- Strong football culture and school spirit
- Affordable tuition with strong ROI

| Academic Environment

Research-focused with strong industry ties. Penn State has a reputation for practical, hands-on education. The engineering and CS programs are rigorous and well-respected. Faculty are accessible and research opportunities are abundant.

| Student Life

Happy Valley is a true college town — everything revolves around Penn State. The football culture is legendary (Beaver Stadium holds 106,000 fans!). The Indian community is large and active. The pace is relaxed and the people are friendly.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program	Level	Duration	Tuition	Highlights
MS in Computer Science	PG	2 Years	\$28K-32K/yr	Strong CS program with specialisations in AI, systems, and software engineering.
MS in Electrical Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$28K-32K/yr	Strong EE program with signal processing, communications, and power systems.
MS in Mechanical Engineering	PG	2 Years	\$28K-32K/yr	Top 20 ME program with thermal systems, design, and manufacturing.
MBA	PG	2 Years	\$45K-50K/yr	Smeal MBA with strong supply chain and consulting focus.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	7.0+ (First Class)
GRE	310+
IELTS	6.5+ (7.0+ recommended)
TOEFL	90+ (100+ recommended)
Work Experience	Not required (2+ yrs for MBA)
LORs	2-3 LORs
SOP	Required
Resume	Required
Interview	MBA only
Application Fee	\$65

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Fall (Aug)	Jan 15	Mar 15
Spring (Jan)	Sep 1	Oct 15

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	\$28,000-32,000/yr
Accommodation	\$7,000-14,000/yr
Food	\$4,000-6,000/yr
Transport	\$500/yr
Health Insurance	\$2,500/yr
Personal	\$3,000-5,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
Penn State Graduate Fellowship	\$5,000-15,000/yr	Merit-based for graduate students	Rolling
Graduate Assistantship	Full tuition + stipend	Teaching or research assistants	Rolling

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

90% PLACEMENT RATE	\$95,000 AVG SALARY	\$170,000 HIGHEST SALARY	500+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

OPT → H-1B → Green Card | Work visa duration: 3 years (STEM OPT)

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	Penn State Indian Students Association — 400+ members
Accommodation	On-campus housing + off-campus apartments
Avg Rent	\$600-1,200/month
Indian Food	India Pavilion, Champs Chicken & Pizza, Indian grocery stores
Weather	Cold snowy winters (-10°C), warm summers (28°C). Beautiful fall foliage.
Transport	Free campus bus (CATA) + walking
Healthcare	University Health Services (on-campus)
Safety	Very safe. Happy Valley has one of the lowest crime rates in the US.

Nightlife & Social Scene

Downtown State College bars. The Phyrst and Champs are legendary. House parties. Football game weekends are massive events.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **Penn State Indian Students Association** — Cultural
- **Penn State Cricket Club** — Sports
- **Penn State Bhangra** — Dance
- **ACM @ Penn State** — Tech
- **AI Club** — Tech
- **Consulting Group** — Professional

11. What Students Say

"Football Saturdays at Beaver Stadium are electric. 106,000 fans — it's an experience like no other."

— **Arjun, MS CS '24**

"Happy Valley lives up to its name. Safe, friendly, and the Indian community is like family."

— **Karan, MS EE '25**

"The ROI is incredible. Top 30 engineering at public school prices."

— **Priya, MBA '24**

Your Pennsylvania Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your Pennsylvania State University application —
SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

